terminology.) The minimal mesh will then be two data products connected by the central platform.

On the other hand, getting less mathematical and more practical, we could think of a single data product connected to a self-serve infrastructure as a platform. As long as such a simple setup would add business benefit, it could serve as a helpful example from a data mesh perspective.

If proven to bring a clear business benefit, even such a small data mesh seed may become a prime success story for expanding the data mesh concept within your organization. To illustrate how a data mesh can bring tangible benefits to an organization, we will show you how the MVP of a data mesh can unlock the potential of data interoperability and enable ML, creating entirely new business capacity at Messflix.

By the end of this chapter, you'll have a firmer grip of data mesh principles, the means for implementing them, and their associated challenges. However, because we are creating an MVP, you'll learn to achieve success using as few resources as possible and with only a small group of people. Such an approach means taking a lot of shortcuts, so think of duct tape and zip-tie solutions as you go. The rest of the book will give you tools and perspectives on how to address those challenges in depth.

3.1 Getting the lay of the land

Before starting your project, you need tools to navigate through the organizational and infrastructural landscape present in the company. To succeed with your tight MVP deadline, you need to identify the path of least resistance while not forgetting about the need to add value to company operations.

NOTE In chapter 2, when describing data mesh development, we put a lot of emphasis on the business case. It's the same when it comes to a data mesh MVP. It doesn't differ from any other MVP in this sense. It needs to show, in a measurable way, the benefits of the new solution.

You may use the following examples as templates, allowing efficient mapping of the environment of your project.